

Whistle Blower Policy

Version 2.0

Document Revision History

REVISION NO.	REVISION DATE	DESCRIPTION OF CHANGE	AUTHOR	REVIEWED BY	APPROVED BY
1.0	1 Jan 2022	Initial Version	Pradnya Dindorkar	Sanyukta Vohra	Sanyukta Vohra
2.0	17 Jan 2023	Updated version	Rekhansh Chopra	Sanyukta Vohra	Sanyukta Vohra

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PURPOSE

Apar's Whistleblowing Policy (hereinafter referred to as "this Policy") is a reference document of Apar Technologies on policy matters relating to the voluntary disclosure of inappropriate, unethical or unlawful behaviour and practices by management or employees.

The purpose of this policy is to –

- a) Provide a platform and mechanism for the employees to voice genuine concerns or grievances about unprofessional conduct without fear of reprisal
- b) Provide an environment that promotes responsible and protected whistle blowing. It reminds Employees and the Management about their duty to report any suspected violation of any law that applies to the company and any suspected violation of the company's values or Apar's ethical Code of Business conduct.

Above all, it is a dynamic source of information about what may be going wrong at various levels within the organisation and which will help the organisation in realigning various processes and take corrective actions as part of good governance practice.

SCOPE

- (a) This Policy applies to all employees of Apar Technologies
- (b) This Policy applies to all matters involving the company's employees (including former employees and irrespective of nature of employment status), customers and any other stakeholders/persons providing services to the organization, including consultants, vendors, independent contractors, external agencies and/or any other party with a business relationship with the company.
- (c) However, it will exclude customer complaints with regards to a problem with a product or service and employee grievances on their employment position.

DEFINITION OF WHISTLEBLOWING

- (a) Whistleblowing is the voluntary disclosure of inappropriate, unethical or unlawful behaviour and practices by the management or employees. It includes how employees, customers and investors are treated. The following are generally accepted as improper and reportable conduct for whistleblowing, of which the list is not exhaustive:
 - Any unlawful or illegal activities, whether criminal or breach in civil law;
 - Breach of policies and/or procedures;
 - Fraud, theft, embezzlement or dishonesty;
 - Corruption/bribery;
 - Bullying and harassment;
 - Actions which can cause physical danger/harm to another person and/or can give rise to risk of damage to properties/assets;
 - Forgery or alteration of any documents belonging to the Company, customers, another Financial Institution, or agents of the Company;
 - Poor or unethical sales practices
 - Conflict of interest;

- Misuse of position or information; and
- Any other similar or related irregularities.

(b) The above should also be read in conjunction with the Apar's Ethical Business conduct Policy.

REPORTING PROCEDURES

Before making your Whistleblower Report you should satisfy yourself that you have reasonable grounds to suspect Reportable Conduct. 'Reasonable grounds to suspect' is based on objective reasonableness of the reasons for the suspicion. In practice, a mere allegation with no supporting information is unlikely to reach that standard. However, a Whistleblower does not need to prove their allegations. In addition, the disclosure can still qualify for protection even if the disclosure turns out to be incorrect.

The process of whistleblowing is as follow -

- i. Any disclosure of whistleblowing to be channeled directly to the designated Committee
- ii. A dedicated email (whistleblower@apar.com) has been established for any whistle-blower to direct their disclosure directly to the designated Committee members.
- iii. The disclosure of whistleblowing may be made in the form of email communication.
- iv. All emails are confidential and treated confidentially.
- v. Employees are encouraged to report any misconduct without the fear of retaliation and backlash.
- vi. To facilitate an investigation into the alleged wrongdoing, where possible and applicable, the following information should be included when making a disclosure:
 - Brief description of the misconduct;
 - The date and location of the incidence;
 - The identity of the wrongdoer;
 - Particulars of witnesses, if any;
 - Supporting evidence and/or documents;
- vii. Where possible, the whistleblower is encouraged to disclose his/her personal details to enable the relevant parties conducting the investigation to contact the Whistleblower for further information:
 - Name; and
 - Contact details - email address and/or telephone number.

As and when requested by the Committee, the HR Department of the respective geography will be required to provide necessary support in terms of investigation, information gathering etc. of any alleged wrongdoing.

INTERNAL INVESTIGATION

After having examined the information disclosed, the designated committee will conduct a detailed investigation. Depending on the outcome of the investigations, the Committee shall recommend the appropriate action(s) to the Management. If the outcome of the investigations confirms the allegations, disciplinary action shall be instituted in accordance with the prevailing policy.

WHISTLEBLOWER PROTECTION

To allow investigations to proceed in an orderly manner, the whistle-blower must observe the following:

- Not to contact the suspected individuals in an effort to determine the facts or demand restitution;
- Not to discuss or divulge the case facts, suspicions, or allegations with/to any other person (both

- internally and externally); and
- To provide cooperation with investigating officers when called upon.

The committee pledges to ensure that all disclosed information, including the identity of the whistle-blower shall be treated with strict confidentiality and is obligated to protect the whistle-blower from all acts of harassment, retaliation, victimization and recrimination from subordinates, peers and superior officers arising from making the disclosure in good faith.

Whistle Blower Members

S. No.	Name	Designation	Email ID
1	Sai Sudhakar	CEO	sais@apar.com
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Apar Technologies reserves the right to alter or append this policy in part or fully based on management's discretion.